

BUT I LIKE FREE STUFF!

We hear you. There are a few free alternatives to bringing the Start Menu that we all knew and loved. Give these a try. We found Start8 to be the best of the bunch, but you might like the alternatives. After all, you can't beat the price!

Classic Shell

This is a free and open-source application that started off when people were unhappy with the Windows 7 Start Menu! The app offers the 'classic' version for the Start Menu and offers some UI tweaks for Windows Explorer as well. The app offers plenty of options and is a great free alternative to bring back the original Start Menu.

Download from www.classicshell.net



Classic Start menu has a lot of settings to tweak!

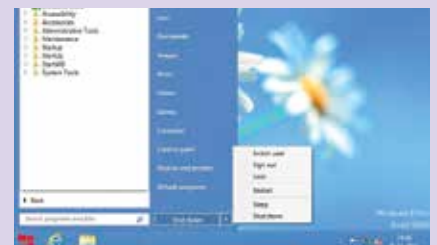
StartW8

This is a donationware application: if you like it, you are encouraged to donate – starting with \$3 (about Rs 160). But you could use it for free, for as long as you wish. The app itself allows you to bring back key Start Menu features: (1) you can start at your desktop when you logon, and it (2) gives you a Windows 7 style Start Menu. It's a simple app for a simple price.

Get it at www.areaguard.com/StartW8



StartW8 offers some basic customization options for the Start Menu display



Bring back the traditional Start Menu under Windows 8 using StartW8

StartIsBack

Not exactly free, StartIsBack comes with a 30-day trial, which can then be upgraded to the full version for \$3 (about Rs 160). For the price you get licenses for 2 PCs. StartIsBack offers much the same features that StartW8 enables: logon directly to the desktop, get back the Start Menu; StartIsBack also adds some customization options to the Start Menu: change the start icons, and the appearance styles. It's slightly more feature-rich than StartW8, give it a try.

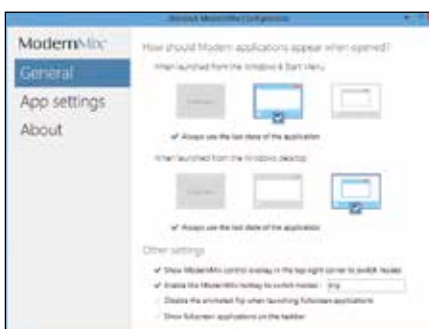
Download from www.startisback.com



StartIsBack gives some visual customization options



You can control some advanced options for StartIsBack under these screens



ModernMix allows you to launch a Modern app in multiple ways



ModernMix remembers the last state of a Modern app's UI. You can override that behaviour here



Lining up all the Modern apps one behind the other thanks to ModernMix!

liking, you can now launch a Modern app just like any other application under Windows. Line them all up, resize them,

and even use the Windows 8 snap to left or right to run two apps next to each other. A Modern app, essentially, is now

just another app under the Windows banner, and it's Microsoft Windows again, and not Microsoft "Window"! **d**